06 | CLEAR REQUESTS | DESK REFERENCE

# Clear Requests: Before You Send

Use for a decision request, an escalation, or a follow-up.

| Step | Check |
|---|---|
| **1. Name the exact decision** | Will the reader know exactly what I'm asking for? |
| **2. Check authority and boundaries** | What can I decide or keep doing? What needs someone else? |
| **3. Gather facts and required input** | What do I know for sure? What's still unconfirmed? Whose input do I need? |
| **4. Offer options and a recommendation** | What are my real options? Which do I recommend, and why? |
| **5. Check who decides and the deadline** | Who decides? Is the deadline real? When will I hear back? |
| **6. Follow up and share the outcome** | Who's tracking this, doing the next step, and updating others? |

## Keep track of three dates

**Decision needed by:** _____ **Reply expected by:** _____

**Next update, if still open:** _____ **Confirmed with:** _____

## Following up

Point back to your original request and the update date you agreed on. Say what's still open, what's new, and what happens if it waits. Check for a reply before you send it again.

> **How fast to expect an answer**
> Escalated questions get an answer, or the name of the person handling them, within two working days. If it'll take longer, expect a date for the next update. Immediate risks and required deadlines go through the urgent process.

*Based on: Decision & Escalation training, six-step request checklist; Communicating CLEAR training, slide 41.*